

Link up with your other email accounts

the 'Add contacts' list that you can access from the 'Menu' button above.

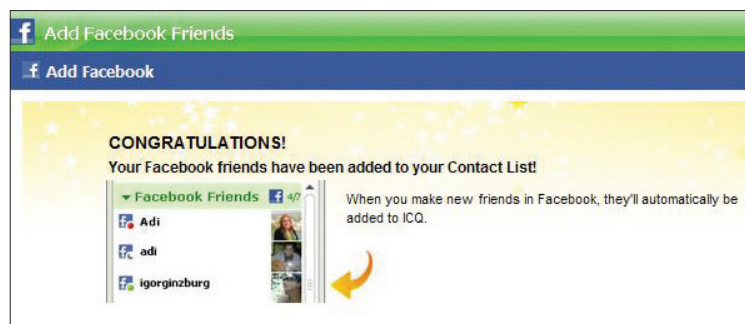
ICQ allows you to bring in all your email contacts from the most popular email sites such as Yahoo, Windows Live and Gmail. Select the one you want, fill in your email id and password (which will not be stored) and click on 'Find'. ICQ will scan your friends list and identify which of them don't have an ICQ account yet. You could uncheck the boxes of the friends you don't want to invite or skip the step altogether.

Connect with Facebook

The great thing about ICQ 7 is that you can finally chat with your Facebook friends through it without having to log in or post messages in Facebook itself. You can write on your wall and bring in updates from Facebook friends directly into ICQ. Click on the big button in the ICQ window, which says 'f-connect'.

If you don't have a Facebook account already (which

planet are you from, anyway?) ICQ allows you to set up one instantly. Otherwise, just 'Log in with Facebook', fill in your Facebook id and password and click on 'Connect'. Click on 'Allow chat' to enable ICQ to pull chat feeds from Facebook in real time. Continue to click



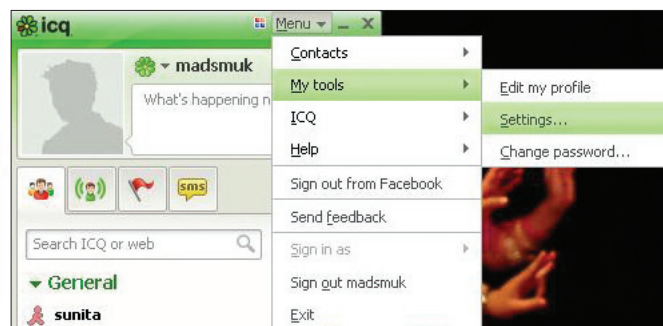
When you see this you're almost done

on the 'Allow' buttons to ensure a seamless and complete interaction with Facebook and you'll soon find that the only reason you'll go to the Facebook site is to play Farmville.

Once you're done, you can see every post that your friends put up as a feed, directly in your ICQ window.



For those who aren't on Facebook



Change how ICQ feels

Personalize

ICQ 7 gives you the option to change how the window looks and sounds. All of this is possible with the help of the 'Customization' features in the 'Settings' window (Menu>My Tools>Settings). To change the

interaction more pleasant to the year. In the 'Tweak my ICQ' menu, click on the 'More Sounds' link.

You have a choice of twenty different sounds under five heads all of which you can preview if you click on 'Play all' button at the bottom-right of the window. Most of them are speech sound-bytes with interesting themes such as 'Drakula's Assistant' and 'Angry French Waiter'. If you're not in the mood for funny lines and exaggerated accents we suggest you stick to the default 'Standard ICQ Sounds'.

appearance of the interface, click on the 'More skins' link under the 'Tweak my ICQ' list of options.

This will take you to <http://download.icq.com/download/skins/>. As this article goes to print, ICQ has yet to add more skins for you to download but keep checking the site because "A new ICQ skins collection for ICQ 7 is on its way".

Luckily, the 'Xtras' site for ICQ is ready with several different sounds that make your

Data Crow 3

If you've got tons of stuff and go crazy looking for things, what you need is a catalogue. You could, perhaps, write it all down in a book. But then again you could use Data Crow.

Data Crow is a free and convenient Java application that lets you ferret out information about virtually anything from the web and add it to a database. Its portability and ease of use makes it a handy tool for keeping track of your collections.



Data Crow lets you have a bird's eye view of almost everything you own